# John C. Flournoy, PhD

Research Scientist, Stats Maven

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## Education

**Ph.D., Psychology, University of Oregon**
Dissertation: *Adolescent Social Motives: Measurement and Implications* 2018

**M.S., Psychology, University of Oregon** 2014

**B.A., Cognitive Science, University of California, Berkeley** 2005

## Work Experience

**Research and Data Science Consultant, Independent** 2018–present

- Clients have included Meru Health (digital mental health analyses), Harvard (HCPD neuroimaging), and academic teams seeking psychometric and causal inference expertise

**Principal Research Scientist, Developer Success Lab, Pluralsight** 2024–2025

- Lead scientist on analysis of yearly ticket data from over 11k developers
- Drove organizational insights across multiple research projects
- Spearheaded community engagement overlay journal at dsl.pubpub.org

**Research Associate, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA** 2018–2024

- Lead analyst on intensive longitudinal fMRI neuroimaging study of mechanisms linking stress to psychopathology in adolescents
- Lead author of report on fMRI measurement reliability
- Supported co-authors on intensive longitudinal digital phenotyping analysis of stress, sleep, digital communication, and physical activity
- Lead analyst of task-based fMRI for multi-site adolescent cognitive control study (NIMH U01-MH109589, $17.1M)
- Developed digital phenotyping data processing for NIMH R37-MH119194 ($9M)
- Provided methodology and scientific computing support across two lab groups
- note: post-doctoral scholar from 2018-2020

**Graduate Research Fellow, University of Oregon, Eugene, OR** 2012–2018

- Developed hierarchical Bayesian model of reinforcement learning for adolescent social motives
- Collected data from 300+ participants, including foster-care-involved adolescents
- Dissertation: *Adolescent Social Motives: Measurement and Implications*
- Developed expertise in longitudinal personality, fMRI, and cognitive task data using multilevel and structural equation modeling
- Validated new self-report and task measures, and evaluated validity and reliability of existing measures

**Research Coordinator, Stanford University, Stanford, CA** 2009–2012

- Coordinated Simons Foundation-funded study on sleep problems in autism using ambulatory polysomnography
- Site coordinator for clinical trial testing a novel PET marker for $\beta$-amyloid in dementia patients

# Publications


Chen, Y. Y., Rosenbaum, G. M., Fan, H., Flournoy, J. C., Li, T., Cegarra, L., Youssoufian, D. A., Grad-Freilich, M. J., Kordyban, L. E., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. H. (2025). Social Contexts Requiring Adjudication between Self- and Peer-Interest Differentially Alter Risk Preferences Across Adolescence. *Open Mind*, *9*, 540–558. https://doi.org/10.1162/opmi_a_00201

Flournoy, J. C., Lee, C. S., Wu, M., & Hicks, C. M. (2025). No silver bullets: Why understanding software cycle time is messy, not magic. *Empirical Software Engineering*, *30*(6), 174. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10664-025-10735-w

Guazzelli Williamson, V., Barendse, M. E. A., Chavez, S. J., Flournoy, J. C., Cheng, T. W., Cosme, D., Byrne, M. L., Allen, N. B., & Pfeifer, J. H. (2025). A longitudinal neuroimaging study of adolescent girls' mentalizing and perspective-taking tendencies. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, *72*, 101526. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dcn.2025.101526

Rakesh, D., Flournoy, J. C., & McLaughlin, K. A. (2025). Associations between socioeconomic status and mental health trajectories during early adolescence: Findings from the Adolescent Brain Cognitive Development study. *JCPP Advances*, *5*(4), e70001. https://doi.org/10.1002/jcv2.70001

Chen, Y. Y., Rosenbaum, G. M., Fan, H., Li, T., Flournoy, J., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. (2024). How beliefs around peers' risk preferences get incorporated into adolescents' decision making. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, *46*(0). Retrieved January 28, 2025, from https://escholarship.org/uc/item/6c42379z

Curtis, M., Flournoy, J. C., Kandala, S., Sanders, A. F. P., Harms, M. P., Omary, A., Somerville, L. H., & Barch, D. M. (2024). Disentangling the unique contributions of age, pubertal stage, and pubertal hormones to brain structure in childhood and adolescence. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, *70*, 101473. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dcn.2024.101473

Flournoy, J. C., Bryce, N. V., Dennison, M. J., Rodman, A. M., McNeilly, E. A., Lurie, L. A., Bitran, D., Reid-Russell, A., Vidal Bustamante, C. M., Madhyastha, T., & McLaughlin, K. A. (2024). A precision neuroscience approach to estimating reliability of neural responses during emotion processing: Implications for task-fMRI. *NeuroImage*, *285*, 120503. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuroimage.2023.120503

Heffer, T., Flournoy, J. C., Baum, G. L., & Somerville, L. H. (2024). Examining the Association between Punishment and Reward Sensitivity and Response Inhibition to Previously-Incentivized Cues across Development. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence*, *53*(6), 1341–1354. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-024-01966-z

Rith-Najarian, L. R., Gong-Guy, E., Flournoy, J. C., & Chavira, D. A. (2024). Randomized controlled trial of a web-based program for preventing anxiety and depression in university students. *Journal of Consulting and Clinical Psychology*, *92*(1), 1–15. https://doi.org/10.1037/ccp0000843

Xu, B., Dall'Aglio, L., Flournoy, J., Bortsova, G., Tervo-Clemmens, B., Collins, P., de Bruijne, M., Luciana, M., Marquand, A., Wang, H., Tiemeier, H., & Muetzel, R. L. (2024). Limited generalizability of multivariate brain-based dimensions of child psychiatric symptoms. *Communications Psychology*, *2*(1), 1–14. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44271-024-00063-y

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Grisanzio, K. A., Flournoy, J. C., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. H. (2023). Shifting qualities of negative affective experience through adolescence: Age-related change and associations with functional outcomes. *Emotion*, *23*(1), 278–288. https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001079

McCormick, E. M., Byrne, M. L., Flournoy, J. C., Mills, K. L., & Pfeifer, J. H. (2023). The Hitchhiker's guide to longitudinal models: A primer on model selection for repeated-measures methods. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, *63*, 101281. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dcn.2023.101281

McLaughlin, K. A., Weissman, D. G., & Flournoy, J. (2023). Challenges with Latent Variable Approaches to Operationalizing Dimensions of Childhood adversity – a Commentary on Sisitsky et al. (2023). *Research on Child and Adolescent Psychopathology*, *51*(12), 1809–1811. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10802-023-01114-4

Xu, B., Dall'Aglio, L., Flournoy, J., Bortsova, G., Tervo-Clemmens, B., Collins, P., Bruijne, M. de, Luciana, M., Marquand, A., Wang, H., Tiemeier, H., & Muetzel, R. L. (2023, March 20). *Multivariate brain-based dimensions of child psychiatric problems: Degrees of generalizability*. https://doi.org/10.1101/2023.03.12.23287158

Barendse, M. E. A., Byrne, M. L., Flournoy, J. C., McNeilly, E. A., Guazzelli Williamson, V., Barrett, A.-M. Y., Chavez, S. J., Shirtcliff, E. A., Allen, N. B., & Pfeifer, J. H. (2022). Multimethod assessment of pubertal timing and associations with internalizing psychopathology in early adolescent girls. *Journal of Psychopathology and Clinical Science*, *131*(1), 14–25. https://doi.org/10.1037/abn0000721

Baum, G. L., Flournoy, J. C., Glasser, M. F., Harms, M. P., Mair, P., Sanders, A. F. P., Barch, D. M., Buckner, R. L., Bookheimer, S., Dapretto, M., Smith, S., Thomas, K. M., Yacoub, E., Essen, D. C. V., & Somerville, L. H. (2022). Graded Variation in T1w/T2w Ratio during Adolescence: Measurement, Caveats, and Implications for Development of Cortical Myelin. *Journal of Neuroscience*, *42*(29), 5681–5694. https://doi.org/10.1523/JNEUROSCI.2380-21.2022

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Nook, E. C., Flournoy, J. C., Rodman, A. M., Mair, P., & McLaughlin, K. A. (2021). High Emotion Differentiation Buffers Against Internalizing Symptoms Following Exposure to Stressful Life Events in Adolescence: An Intensive Longitudinal Study. *Clinical Psychological Science*, 21677026209797 86. https://doi.org/10.1177/2167702620979786

Rodman, A. M., Vidal Bustamante, C. M., Dennison, M. J., Flournoy, J. C., Coppersmith, D. D. L., Nook, E. C., Worthington, S., Mair, P., & McLaughlin, K. A. (2021). A Year in the Social Life of a Teenager: Within-Persons Fluctuations in Stress, Phone Communication, and Anxiety and Depression. *Clinical Psychological Science*, 2167702621991804. https://doi.org/10.1177/2167702621991804

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Barendse, M. E. A., Vijayakumar, N., Byrne, M. L., Flannery, J. E., Cheng, T. W., Flournoy, J. C., Nelson, B. W., Cosme, D., Mobasser, A., Chavez, S. J., Hval, L., Brady, B., Nadel, H., Helzer, A., Shirtcliff, E. A., Allen, N. B., & Pfeifer, J. H. (2020). Study Protocol: Transitions in Adolescent Girls (TAG). *Frontiers in Psychiatry*, *10*. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyt.2019.01018

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Vijayakumar, N., Flournoy, J. C., Mills, K. L., Cheng, T. W., Mobasser, A., Flannery, J. E., Allen, N. B., & Pfeifer, J. H. (2020). Getting to know me better: An fMRI study of intimate and superficial self-disclosure to friends during adolescence. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, *118*(5), 885–899. https://doi.org/10.1037/pspa0000182

Byrne, M. L., Chavez, S., Vijayakumar, N., Cheng, T. W., Flournoy, J., Barendse, M., Shirtcliff, E. A., Allen, N., & Pfeifer, J. (2019). Multi-method confirmatory factor analyses of puberty in early adolescent girls. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/pue6f

Flournoy, J. (2019, January 11). *Adolescent Social Motives: Measurement and Implications*. Retrieved January 6, 2020, from https://scholarsbank.uoregon.edu/xmlui/handle/1794/24216

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